

All-Party Parliamentary Groups

A statistical and social-network audit of the UK Parliament Register, edition 260413

553

APPGs in register

2198

Officer roles

722

Distinct MPs / peers

3123

Co-officer pairs

The Register of All-Party Parliamentary Groups names roughly four officers per group: a Chair (or Co-Chairs), a Treasurer, and a small number of Vice-Chairs / Officers. This report ingests every APPG in edition 260413, resolves each named officer to a Parliament member ID via the Members API (with a Wikidata fallback for hard cases), and computes simple aggregate statistics plus a bipartite-projection social network of the MPs and peers who serve together.

Resolution coverage: 2170 of 2198 officer roles (98.7%) auto-matched to a member id. The remaining 28 are same-name collisions among peers (e.g. an inheritance transition) and are surfaced for human review, not silently dropped.

Source: publications.parliament.uk/pa/cm/cmallparty/260413/. Generated 2026-05-03 by forgetmenot. Data is licensed under the Open Parliament Licence.

1 · Group sizes

How many officers does a typical APPG have? The Register requires four officers minimum (a Registered Contact plus three more), and most groups carry exactly four. A small number have eight or more, where Co-Chairs and multiple Vice-Chairs are used.

Officers per APPG (matched-officer count)



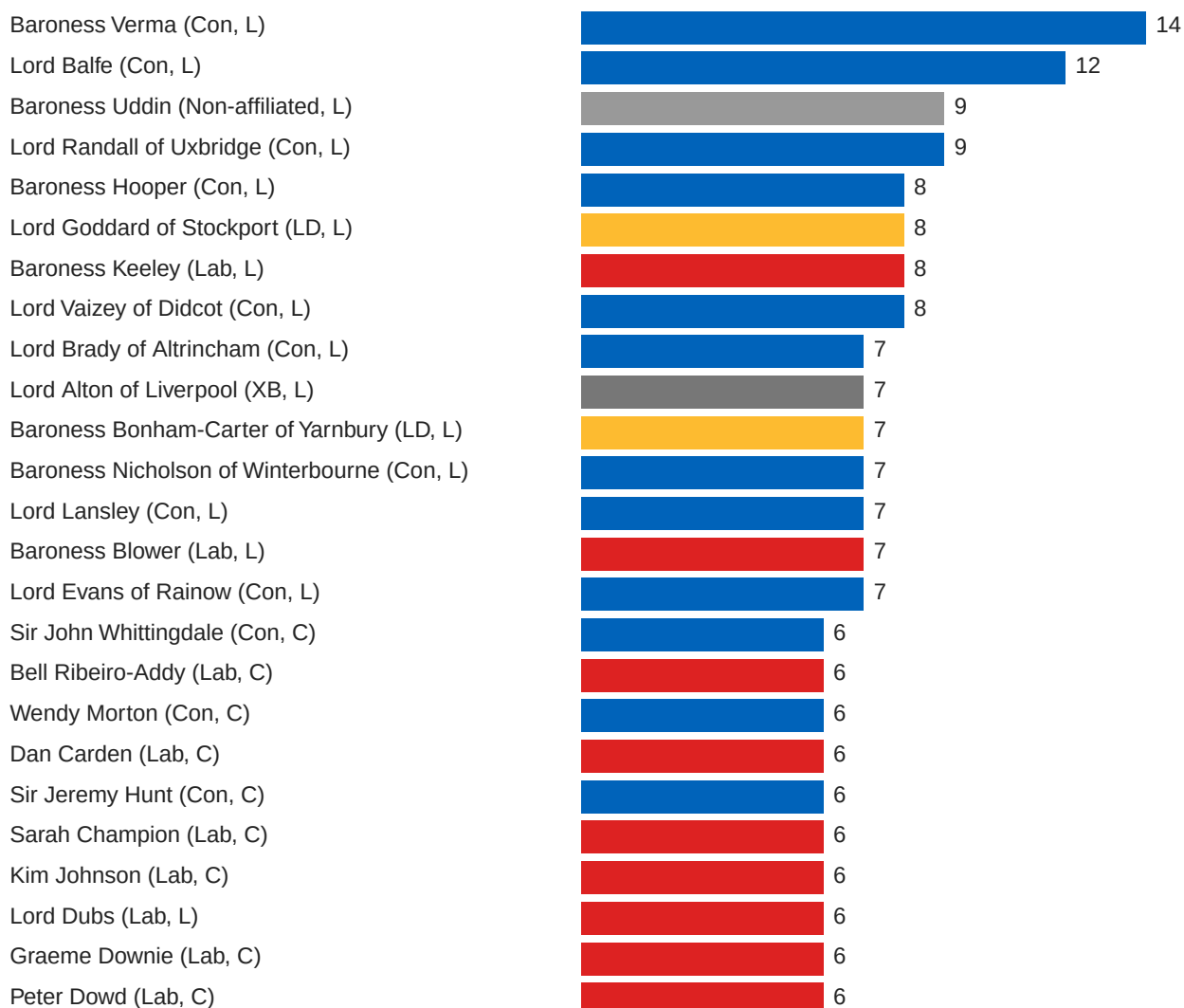
Subject vs Country groups



Country groups are organised around a country or region; subject groups around a topic ("Cancer", "Beer", "Football", "AI").

2 · Most-officering members

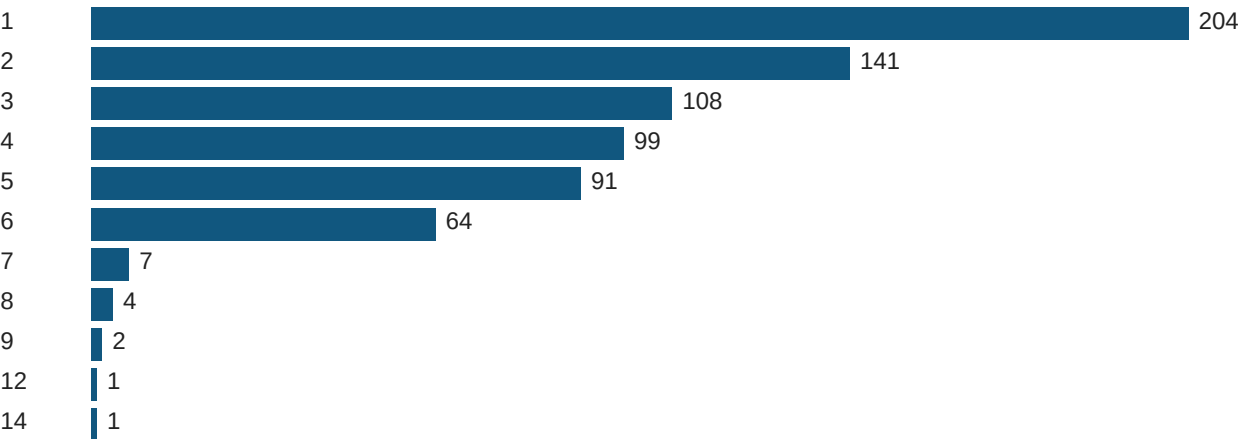
A small number of MPs and peers sit on many APPGs. The list below is the top 25 by the number of distinct groups they appear on as an officer.



Bars coloured by the member's party. C = Commons, L = Lords.

3 · Officer-load distribution

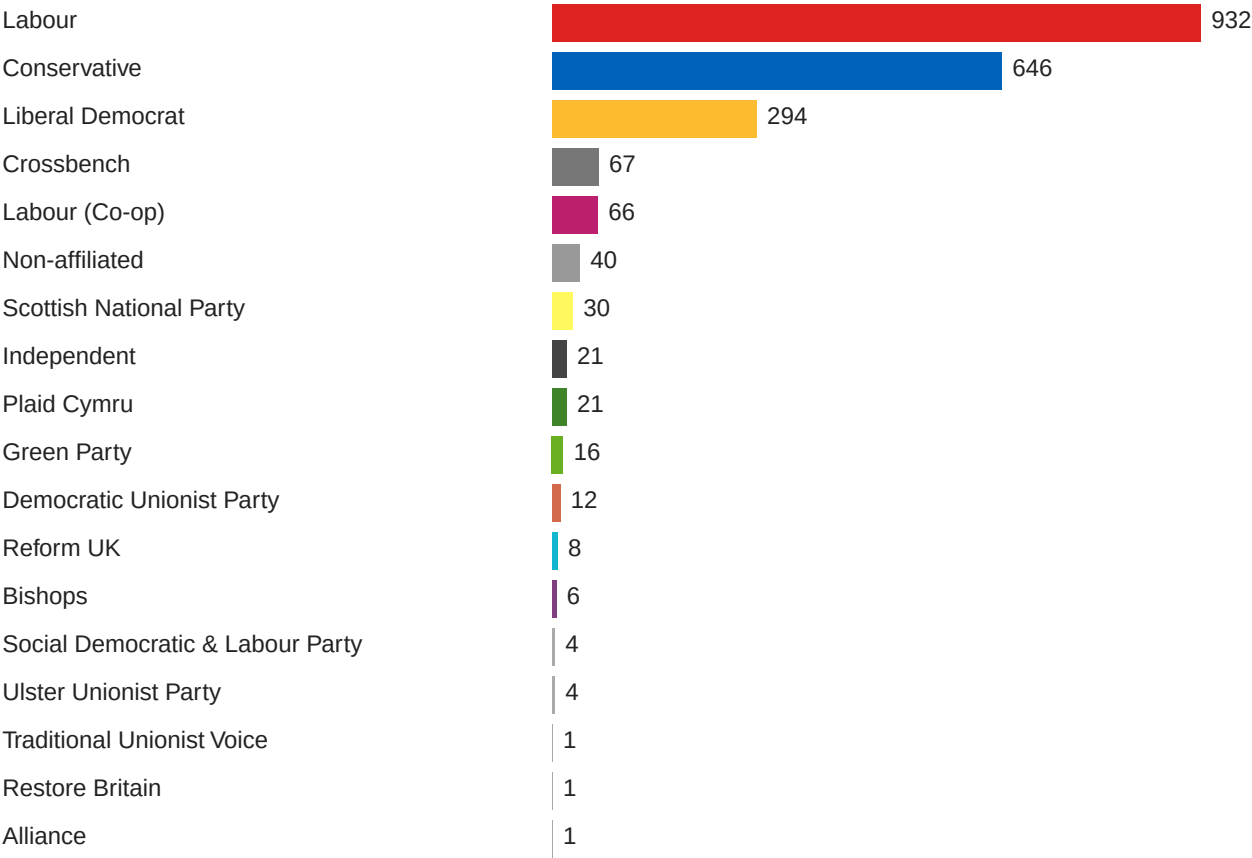
Most members holding any APPG officership hold one or two. A long tail of "super-joiners" hold 10+. The histogram below counts members by number of APPG officerships held.



Y-axis: bin (number of APPGs held). X-bar length: count of members with that many officerships.

4 · Party composition of officer roles

Total officer roles held by members of each party, summed across every APPG.

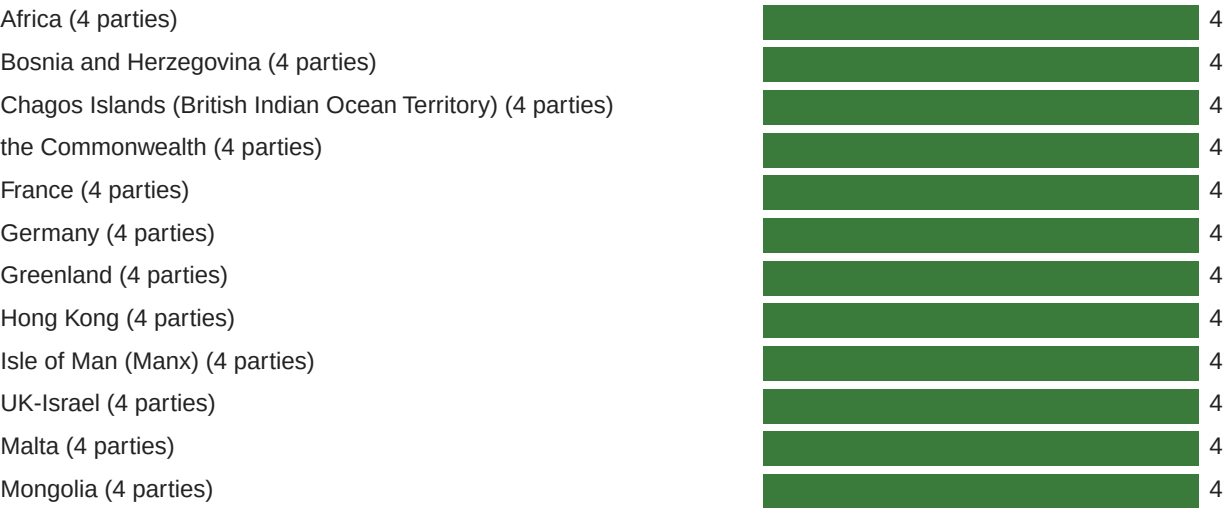


A party with N officer roles is not the same as N distinct members - most members hold multiple officerships.

5 · Cross-party co-officership

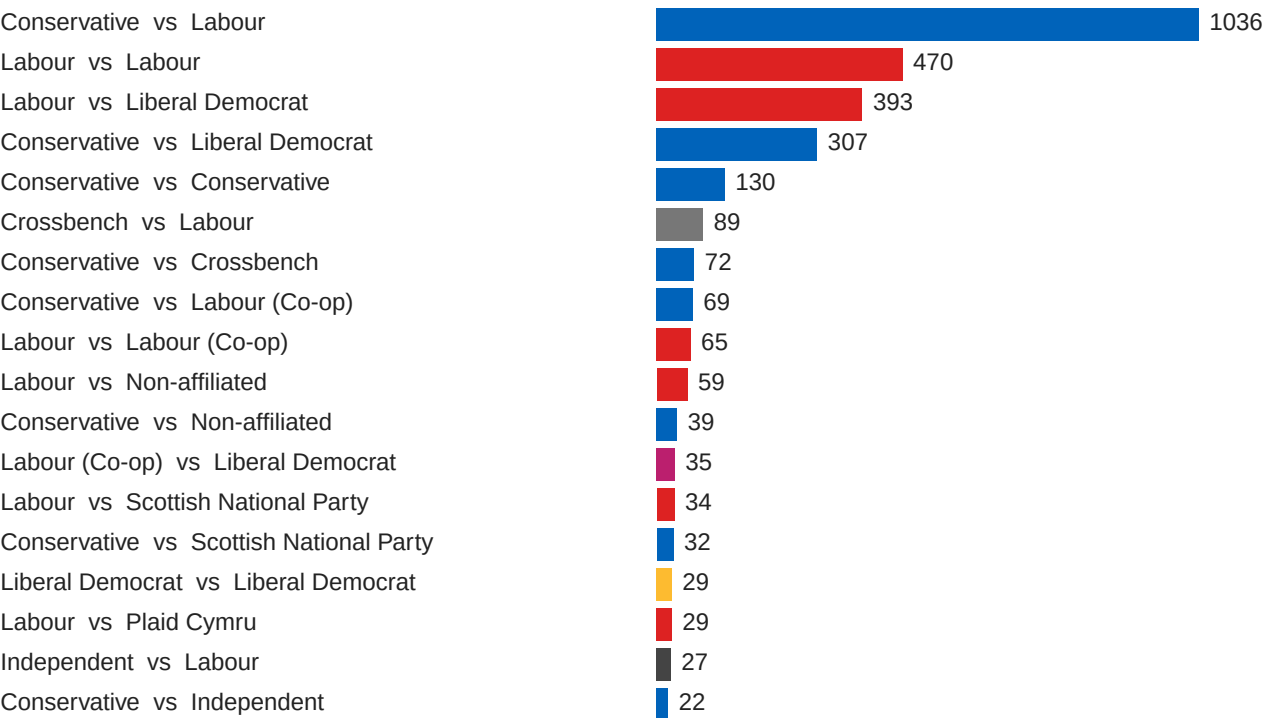
APPGs are intended to be cross-party. To measure how cross-party each group is in practice, we count distinct parties among each group's resolved officers (Shannon entropy, in nats - higher = more diverse).

Most cross-party APPGs



Most-frequent party pairings on APPG benches

Sum, across all APPGs, of unordered party pairs among matched officers. Pairs reflect how often each party-pair shares an APPG officer roster.



6 · Top co-officering MP pairs

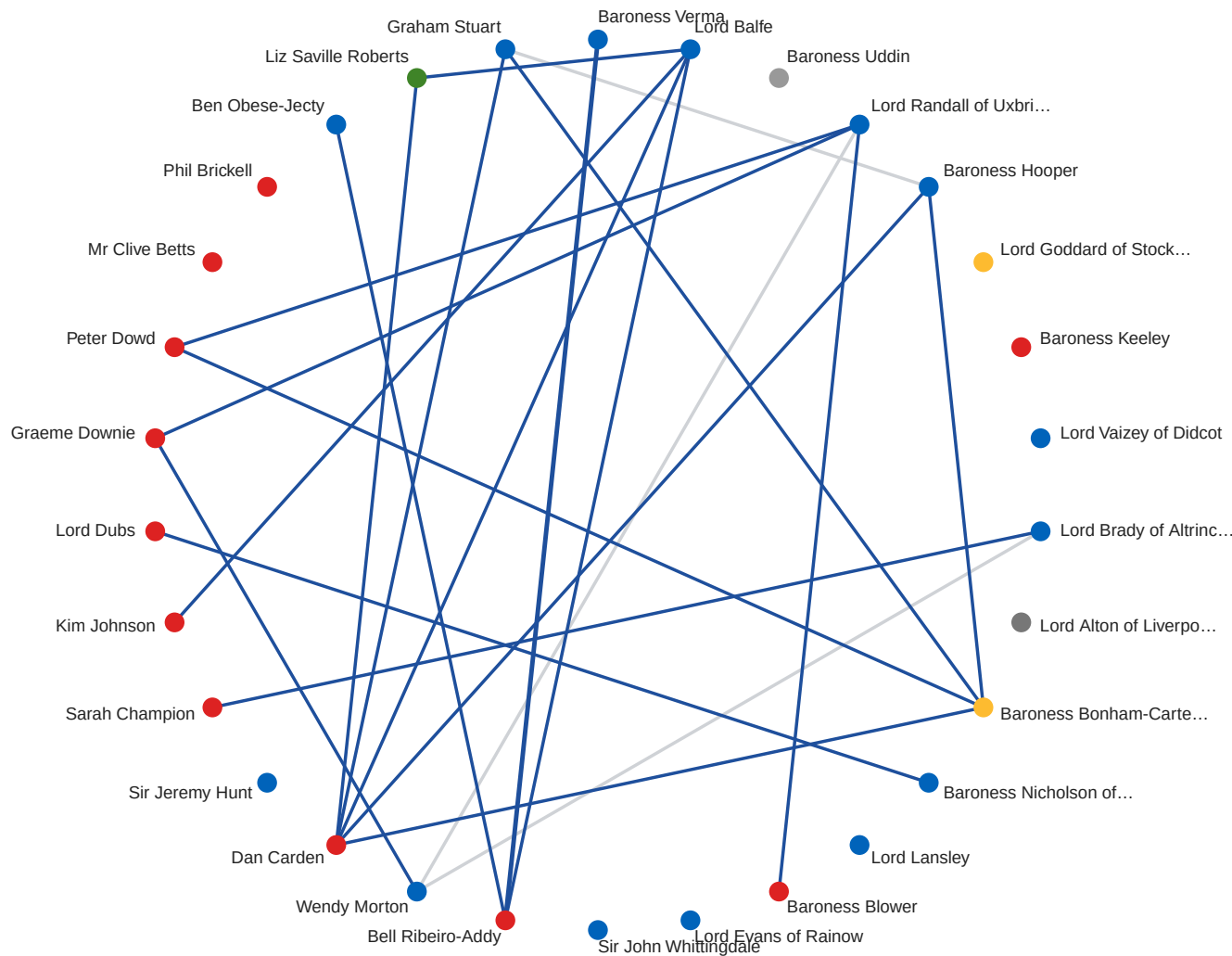
Pairs of members who hold officer roles together on multiple APPGs. The bipartite Member ->APPG graph is projected onto a Member ->Member graph, with edge weight = number of shared groups. The 25 strongest edges are listed below.

Baroness Uddin (Non-affiliated) - Tahir Ali (Lab)	3 groups
Mr Calvin Bailey (Lab) - Ben Obese-Jecty (Con)	3 groups
Baroness Verma (Con) - Dan Aldridge (Lab)	3 groups
Dame Harriett Baldwin (Con) - Kate Osamor (Lab)	2 groups
Chris Law (SNP) - Lord McInnes of Kilwinning (Con)	2 groups
Andrew Rosindell (RUK) - Adam Jogee (Lab)	2 groups
Bell Ribeiro-Addy (Lab) - Apsana Begum (Lab)	2 groups
Grahame Morris (Lab) - Lord Balfé (Con)	2 groups
Mike Wood (Con) - Bambos Charalambous (Lab)	2 groups
Lord Dubs (Lab) - Chris Law (SNP)	2 groups
Lord Touhig (Lab) - Ben Lake (PC)	2 groups
Martin Vickers (Con) - Wendy Morton (Con)	2 groups
Baroness Verma (Con) - Lord Bilimoria (XB)	2 groups
Baroness Bonham-Carter of Yarnbury (LD) - Manuela Perteghella (LD)	2 groups
Helen Grant (Con) - Marsha De Cordova (Lab)	2 groups
Baroness Mobarik (Con) - Imran Hussain (Lab)	2 groups
Sir Iain Duncan Smith (Con) - Lord Alton of Liverpool (XB)	2 groups
Dr Rosena Allin-Khan (Lab) - Rosie Duffield (Ind)	2 groups
Baroness Hooper (Con) - Florence Eshalomi (Lab)	2 groups
Gareth Thomas (Lab) - Lord Davies of Gower (Con)	2 groups
Sir Andrew Mitchell (Con) - Lord Mendelsohn (Lab)	2 groups
Sir Andrew Mitchell (Con) - Lord Polak (Con)	2 groups
Lord Mendelsohn (Lab) - Lord Polak (Con)	2 groups
Baroness Verma (Con) - Bell Ribeiro-Addy (Lab)	2 groups
Irene Campbell (Lab) - Dr Danny Chambers (LD)	2 groups

Each row is one MP ->MP edge. Cross-party edges are the most useful "MPs who actually worked together across parties" signal.

7 · Co-officership network

A circular layout of the 30 members with the most APPG officerships. An edge is drawn between every pair that share at least one APPG; line thickness is scaled by the number of shared groups. Cross-party edges are coloured dark blue (the politically interesting signal); within-party edges are subtle grey. Layout is fixed circular - distance carries no meaning.



Nodes coloured by party. 22 edges shown, of which 19 are cross-party. Edge thickness scales with $\log(1 + \text{shared APPGs})$.

Methodology and caveats

Sources

- Register of All-Party Parliamentary Groups, edition 260413, from publications.parliament.uk. Republished by the Office of the Parliamentary Commissioner for Standards every ~6 weeks. Each group page lists Chair, Co-Chair(s), Treasurer, Vice-Chairs and Officers as plain text strings.
- UK Parliament Members API for resolving officer names to canonical member records (id, party, house, constituency).

Resolution algorithm

Names are normalised by stripping honorifics (Dame, Sir, Lord, Baroness, "Rt Hon", post-nominals MP/KC/CBE etc.) and the cleaned full name is searched first. If that returns nothing, surname-only is tried. Hits are scored by token overlap, party match, house implied by title, and current-membership status; the top score wins. Genuine same-name peer collisions (e.g. inheritance transitions) are reported as ambiguous rather than guessed.

Caveats

- 28 of 2198 officer roles (1.3%) remain ambiguous and are NOT counted in the network projection.
- "Officers" is a small fixed set per APPG (typically four). The wider membership of each group is not in the Register; co-membership beyond officer level can be substantial and is invisible here.
- Cross-party metrics weigh every officer equally regardless of role. A four-officer group with a Chair from one party and three Vice-Chairs from another is "two-party" by our count, but the chairing party has more agenda-setting power.
- The Register lags real life by a few weeks. A handful of officers who recently stepped down or were succeeded may not be reflected.
- Source data is under the Open Parliament Licence. This report is computed by ``forgetmenot``; reproduce with ``node scripts/appg-analysis.mjs && node scripts/appg-report.mjs``.